

Learn new TOOLS

Friday, 31 July 2026 10:03 am

1. Tool Familiarisation

Watch introductory YouTube videos and gain a basic understanding of the following tools:

- a. JIRA, Confluence, Visio, Draw.io, Trello, Microsoft Planner, OneNote, Microsoft Office Suite, Microsoft Outlook & Teams, Git, GitHub & Bitbucket, SharePoint & OneDrive, Power BI, Lucidchart, Microsoft Forms, Excel, Notepad++, PowerShell Script & Batch Script, winmerge, keyPASS

b. For each tool Write **4 simple lines** explaining:

- What the tool is
- What it is used for
- Who typically uses it
- One key benefit or feature

Note: You may use AI assistance, but make sure you read and understand the content. These tools may be discussed and I will ask during class.

c. Add these to your PART B - resume

	Brief explanation of the tool	What it is used for	One key benefit or feature	Importance for BA and Data Analyst roles
JIRA	A project management and issue-tracking tool commonly used in Agile software development environments.	Managing user stories, requirements, tasks, bugs, sprint planning, backlog management, and tracking development progress.	Strong Agile workflow support with sprint boards and issue tracking.	Very High (BA) – Essential for Agile BAs to manage requirements, communicate with developers, and track delivery. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful when working in analytics projects managed through Agile methods.
Confluence	A team collaboration and documentation platform used to create and maintain knowledge bases.	Documenting business requirements, meeting notes, process documentation, system specifications, and project knowledge.	Centralised documentation with easy collaboration and version history.	Very High (BA) – One of the most important tools for requirement documentation and knowledge management. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for documenting analysis results and methodologies.
Microsoft Visio	A diagramming and visual modelling tool for creating business and technical diagrams.	Creating process maps, flowcharts, system architecture diagrams, BPMN diagrams, and organisational charts.	Professional business process modelling capabilities.	Very High (BA) – Critical for process analysis, workflow mapping, and stakeholder communication. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for data flow and system process visualisation.
Draw.io (diagrams.net)	A free online diagramming tool for creating visual representations of processes and systems.	Creating flowcharts, ER diagrams, UML diagrams, architecture diagrams, and workflows.	Free and easy-to-use alternative to Visio with cloud integration.	High (BA) – Useful for modelling processes and requirements. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for database relationships and data workflows.
Trello	A lightweight project management tool based on Kanban boards.	Managing tasks, project activities, workflows, and team collaboration.	Simple visual task management using cards and boards.	Medium (BA) – Useful for smaller projects and task tracking. Low-Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for organising analysis tasks.
Microsoft Planner	A task management application integrated with Microsoft 365.	Creating project plans, assigning tasks, monitoring progress, and managing team activities.	Integration with Microsoft Teams and Office ecosystem.	Medium (BA) – Useful for project coordination and stakeholder activities. Low-Medium (Data Analyst) – Helpful for managing analytics projects.
OneNote	A digital note-taking application from Microsoft.	Recording meeting notes, interview findings, research notes, and requirements discussions.	Flexible organisation of notes with tagging and search.	High (BA) – Useful for capturing stakeholder discussions and requirements. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for documenting analysis processes.
Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, etc.)	A productivity suite containing business applications for documentation, analysis, and presentations.	Creating reports, requirement documents, presentations, spreadsheets, and business analysis deliverables.	Industry-standard business productivity tools.	Very High (BA) – Required for documentation, reporting, and stakeholder communication. Very High (Data Analyst) – Excel and PowerPoint are frequently used for analysis and reporting.
Microsoft Outlook & Teams	Communication and collaboration tools within Microsoft 365.	Email communication, meetings, workshops, stakeholder discussions, and team collaboration.	Integrated communication and scheduling features.	Very High (BA) – Critical for stakeholder engagement and requirement workshops. High (Data Analyst) – Important for collaboration and presenting findings.
Git	A distributed version control system for tracking changes in files and code.	Managing source code, scripts, version history, and collaboration between developers and analysts.	Tracks changes and supports team collaboration.	Medium (BA) – Useful for technical BA roles working with development teams. High (Data Analyst) – Important for managing SQL scripts, Python notebooks, and analytics projects.
GitHub & Bitbucket	Online platforms for hosting Git repositories and managing software projects.	Storing code, collaborating on projects, reviewing changes, and managing development workflows.	Supports collaboration, code review, and project tracking.	Medium (BA) – Useful for technical BAs involved in software projects. High (Data Analyst) – Important for sharing analytical code and version control.
SharePoint & OneDrive	Microsoft cloud storage and document management platforms.	Managing project documents, sharing files, maintaining documentation, and collaboration.	Secure cloud-based file storage with access control.	Very High (BA) – Important for document management and governance. High (Data Analyst) – Useful for storing datasets, reports, and analysis files.
Power BI	Microsoft's business intelligence and data visualisation platform.	Creating dashboards, reports, data models, KPIs, and interactive visualisations.	Powerful data visualisation and business intelligence capabilities.	Very High (Data Analyst) – One of the most important tools for reporting and insights generation. High (BA) – Valuable for requirement analysis and communicating business insights.
Lucidchart	A cloud-based diagramming and visual collaboration tool.	Creating process maps, system diagrams, workflows, and brainstorming diagrams.	Real-time collaboration with easy sharing.	High (BA) – Useful for remote workshops and process modelling. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for visualising data processes.
Microsoft Forms	An online survey and data collection tool.	Collecting feedback, conducting surveys, gathering requirements, and capturing user input.	Simple form creation with automatic response collection.	High (BA) – Useful for stakeholder feedback and requirement gathering. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for collecting datasets for analysis.
Excel	A spreadsheet application used for calculations, analysis, and reporting.	Data cleaning, analysis, pivot tables, formulas, charts, financial analysis, and reporting.	Flexible data analysis capabilities with powerful functions.	Very High (Data Analyst) – One of the core analytical tools required. Very High (BA) – Essential for reporting, requirement analysis, and business modelling.
Notepad++	A lightweight text editor supporting multiple programming and scripting languages.	Editing scripts, configuration files, SQL queries, logs, and text-based data.	Fast and supports many programming languages.	Medium (BA) – Useful for technical documentation and reviewing files. Medium-High (Data Analyst) – Useful for editing SQL, scripts, and data files.
PowerShell Script & Batch Script	Automation scripting tools used in Windows environments.	Automating repetitive tasks, system administration, data processing, and workflow automation.	Improves efficiency by automating manual tasks.	Medium (BA) – Useful for technical BA roles involving system processes. High (Data Analyst) – Useful for automating data preparation and repetitive tasks.
WinMerge vs Beyond Compare	A file and folder comparison tool used to identify differences between files.	Comparing documents, code files, configuration files, and requirement changes.	Quickly highlights differences between versions.	High (BA) – Useful for comparing requirement documents and change requests. Medium (Data Analyst) – Useful for validating datasets or scripts.
KeePass (KeyPASS)	A password management tool that securely stores passwords and credentials.	Managing secure access credentials for systems, databases, and applications.	Strong encryption and secure password storage.	Medium (BA) – Useful when managing multiple project environments and accounts. Medium (Data Analyst) – Important for secure access management.